

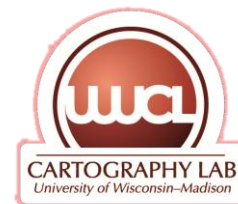
Unit 2: Team Formation & Brainstorming | 12.05.25 11:30–13:00
Picking Your SDG & Brainstorming Your Topic!

Objectives for the Day

- 1. Connect data to stories:** Combine official SDG indicators with personal or community-based experiences
- 2. Practice design as an argument:** Use visual form—map style, symbols, layout—as part of the message
- 3. Reflect on information complexity:** Highlight contradictions, uncertainties, and/or alternatives
- 4. Collaborate across contexts:** Discover shared experiences within your team, particularly if you come from different regions



Schedule at a Glance



Day 1 // Monday 12.05.25

- **Unit 1: Introductions & Inspiration Talks**
 - 10:00 to 10:15 // Arrival (and coffee!)
 - 10:15 to 10:30 // Introductions from Georg Gartner and Robert Roth
 - 10:30 to 10:45 // Inspiration Talk 1: The United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (Ayako Kagawa)
 - 10:45 to 11:00 // Inspiration Talk 2: Tips for Mapping the SDGs (Robert Roth)
 - 11:00 to 11:15 // Inspiration Talk 3: Making an Atlas in a Day (Alicia Cowart)

- 11:15 to 11:30 // Break

• Unit 2: Team Formation

- 11:30 to 12:00 // Picking Your SDG (rank your top three SDG themes, narrow into small groups, facilitated by Robert Roth)
- 12:00 to 13:00 // Brainstorming Your Story (breakouts with Alicia Cowart, Merve Keskin, N.T. Nawshin, Robert Roth, Zdenek Stachon, and available TUW staff)

- 13:00 to 14:00 // Lunch

• Unit 3: Design Sprint 1, Obtaining Your Data, Researching Your Topic

- 14:00 to 15:30 // Team Work (organizers available for questions)

- 15:30 to 16:00 // Creative Break, the Marshmallow Challenge (facilitated by Robert Roth)

• Unit 4: Design Sprint 2, Sketching & Organizing Your Visual Story

- 16:00 to 17:30 // Team Work (organizers available for questions) *The goal is to have cleaned, mappable data in a GIS by day's end*
- 17:30+ // Continue Work As Needed (Optional)

Day 2 // Tuesday 13.05.25

- **Unit 5: Design Sprint 3, Polishing Your Visual Story**
 - 14:30 to 15:00 // Adobe Illustrator Demo
 - 15:00 to 17:00 // Team Work (organizers available for questions) *The goal is to be out of GIS and into Adobe Illustrator by day's end*
 - 17:00+ // Continue Work As Needed (Optional)

Day 3 // Wednesday 14.05.25

- Initial Drafts Due in Google Slides by 16:00
- **Unit 6: Team Presentations & Draft Feedback**
 - 16:00 to 18:00 // Presentations
- 18:00+ // Social (!) *Recommendations appreciated!*

Day 4 // Thursday 15.05.25

- Second Drafts Due to Rob by 16:00
- PhD Student Show and Tell (N.T. Nawshin, Gareth Baldrice-Franklin) *Contact Rob if you are interested in giving a 5-10 minute lightning talk*
- 18:00+ // PhD Student Social (Alicia and Rob will crash!) *Recommendations appreciated!*

Unit 2 Objectives

1. Appraise the 17 SDGs based on experiences and interests
2. Organize into small groups according to mutual interests in the SDGs
3. Discuss professional and research interests in the SDGs
4. Formulate potential data-driven stories about an SDG
5. Apply unique experiences and interests to SDG stories





Storytelling Prompts:

1. What is the main point of your proposed project?

- What is necessary **background context** for understanding your SDG map? i.e., What is the most relevant indicator?
- What is the key **problem** driving your story? i.e., Why should we care?
- What is main **conclusion** of your story? i.e., What do you want audiences to remember?

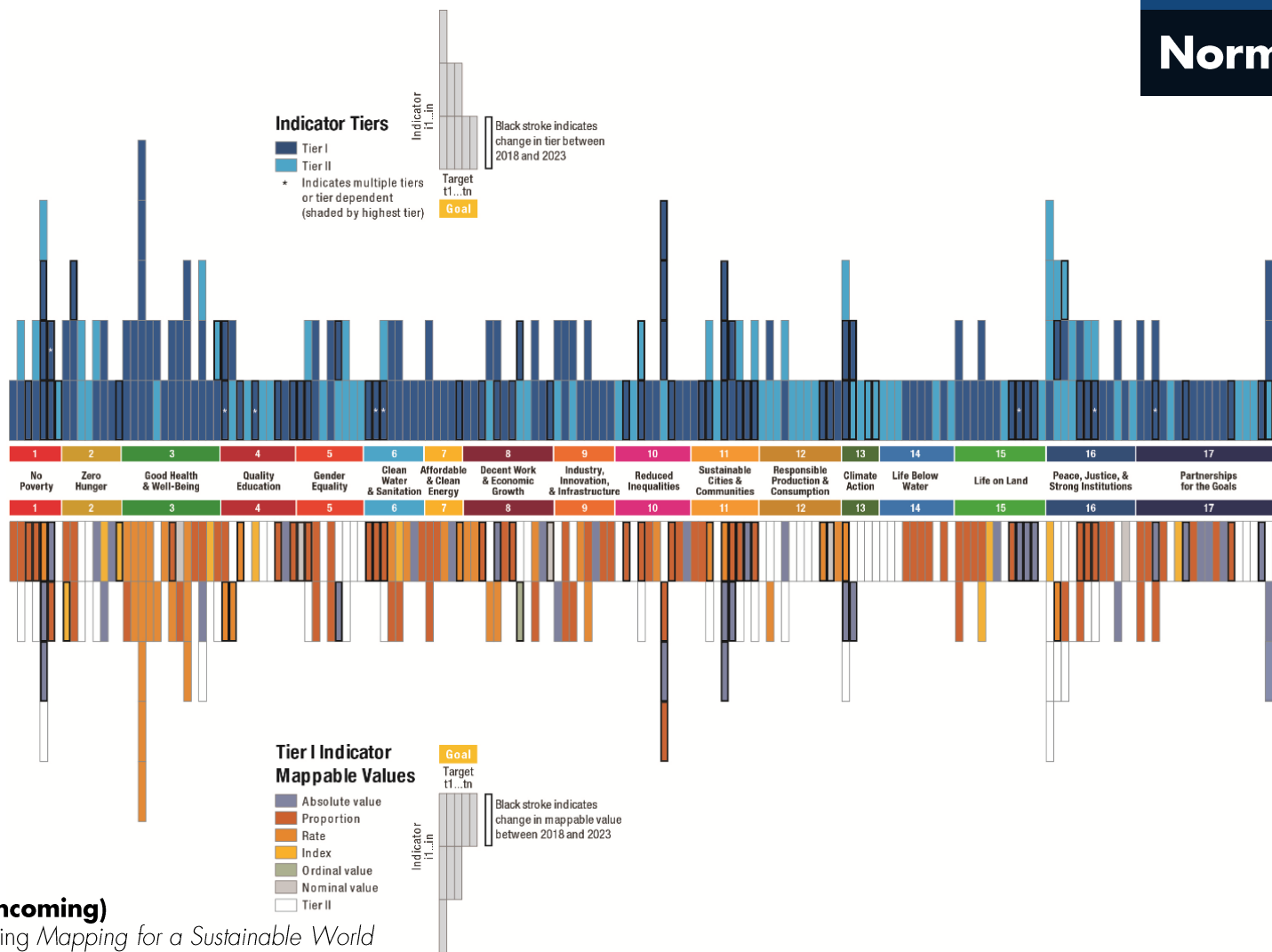
2. Which place(s) are important regarding your topic?

- i.e., Who are the **character(s)** of your story? What is their cartographic scale? i.e., regions, countries, cities, etc.
- Begin looking at indicator data patterns: What **outliers** (high and low) or **changes** make interesting juxtapositions?
- From your experiences, what **alternatives or solutions** do these places represent? How should they change in the future?

3. What will your atlas spread include?

- What **maps, charts, images, and commentary** is important to tell your story?
- What do the SDG indicators show and **what do the data not show**?
- How do you want audiences to **feel** while reading the map and **behave** differently after seeing your map?

Normalization



Roth et al. (forthcoming)

Making and Remaking Mapping for a Sustainable World